

Purpose of policy

To provide a safe working environment for the patient, staff, and public without compromising healthcare standards and to ensure safe handling and disposal of Infection and sharps waste by healthcare operators and workers in medical facilities in Royal Hospital, especially for those who are likely to be exposed to hazardous materials.

Scope

This guideline is applicable to all healthcare workers, domestic, cleaning staff, and other workers including contracted service workers in healthcare facilities who handle or may come in contact with potentially contaminated Infections.

Definition

Sharp waste:

Items capable of puncturing, cutting, or abrading the skin such as glass or plastic pipettes, broken glass, test tubes, Petri dishes, razor blades, needles, and syringes with needles.

Sharp container:

- Sharps containers must be rigid, puncture-proof, leak-proof, and closable.
- All designated infectious waste containers should have a biohazard label or be color-coded

Roles & Responsibilities

A. All Patient Care Staff

- All staff should comply with this guideline and report any hazards or incidents immediately to their supervisors, HSE and IP&C.
- Properly segregate and dispose of sharp waste
- Should be aware of the risks posed by handling sharp waste.
- Never place sharps containers at floor level, keep sharps containers in an area that excludes risk of injury to staff and visitors.

B. Hospital management:

- Provide all required resources for the implementation of this guideline

C. Departmental Management

- Enforce this guideline
- Education and training of staff on safe disposal of sharp waste

D. Infection prevention and control

- Monitor compliance with guidelines during environmental audits.
- Investigate sharp inoculation injuries.
- Provide feedback to the health safety and environment committee

E. Health, Safety, and Environment Technician

- Provide education and training regarding handling and disposal of sharp waste.
- Regular inspection to insure safe disposal and handling of sharp waste

F. Housekeeping Staff:

- Responsible for collection and transport of sharp waste to the dumping area according to this policy.

Container labeling:

Each Container must have a label that identifies the date of first utilization, the name of the ward, and the date of collection before disposal.

Collection of waste:

Housekeeping services should:

- Dispose of the sharp box when it is $\frac{3}{4}$ th full.
- Do not use hands to compress (squeeze) waste in containers
- Fasten the cover of a full sharps container securely before placing them in yellow bags and store in a temporary holding area such as a dirty utility room.
- Do not store sharps containers in hallways or corridors.
- Decontaminate carts used for transporting waste within the hospital daily using a hospital-approved disinfectant solution.
- Use leak-proof carts that are readily cleanable to transport sharp\infectious waste from the point of generation or storage to the point of disposal and treatment.
- Pick up and discard broken glass using a mechanical device such as a forceps or a brush and dustpan.
- Broken glass should never be handled with gloved or non-gloved hands.

Storage

- Storage facility at Royal hospital is outside the building, locked and a sign is posted at the entrance.
- There is a restriction of access to this area
- Sharp wastes are stored in rigid wall containers yellow with biohazard signs for clinical.

Transport

- During movement of waste must be maintained and the batch of waste managed according to the component with the highest level of risk.
- The staff should wear Personal, Protective equipment such as gloves and aprons during the transport of waste

On-site transport

On-site transport of waste is usually from the initial storage point to an assembly storage or treatment area by means of trolleys, which have a solid base and bounding to contain spills. Trolleys used for the movement of clinical wastes are designed to prevent leakage, are easily cleaned, and minimize manual handling. Waste collection rounds should be performed so as to minimize housekeeping hazards associated with the storage of waste at 'user' sites.

Off-site transport

Relevant authorities must be contacted for special requirements for the transport of clinical wastes/sharp waste.

Disposal of waste:

-Used sharps containers are to be disposed of in accordance with the Health, Safety, and Environment Guideline and Be'ah Company procedures for last disposal.

Send to be'ah for final disposal (Autoclaved)

Sharps waste disposal (SHRP)

Sharps means discarded items that can induce subdermal inoculation of infectious agents, including needles, scalpel blades, Pasteur pipettes, broken glass, and other sharp items derived from human or animal patient care, laboratories, and research facilities.

Disposal procedure

- All sharps are required to be disposed of in puncture-resistant sharps disposal containers.
- Label all radioactive sharps containers with "Caution Radioactive Material" tape to avoid mixing with non-radioactive sharps.
- Do not overfill sharps containers.
- Disposal containers must be shut (i.e. capped or tapped) prior to being collected and transported.
- Do not place sharps containers inside of a solid radioactive waste container.
- When the sharps container is full, change it with a new one and record it in the department log book.

Injuries related to improper sharps disposal and handling can occur for the following reasons:

- Inappropriate sharps usage and handling practices during the provision of care by a healthcare professional.
- Disposal of sharps in general or medical waste bins and not in sharps containers.
- Improper design of sharps disposal container.
- Inappropriate placement of sharps disposal container.
- Overfilling of sharps disposal container

Occupational health and safety:

The hospital must ensure that Sharp waste is handled and disposed of safely. The waste management plan and procedures should be readily available to all workers involved.

All personnel who handle clinical and related waste must have access to information about:

- Occupational hazards of unprotected exposure;
- Policies and procedures for specific waste handling and prevention of injury and

disease

- Personal protective equipment
- Immunization for Hepatitis B
- Access to medical care and counseling services in case of exposure to hazardous wastes
- Availability and access to first aid resources.

Sharp/Needle sticks injury:

Refer to the policy of management of needle stick injuries & incidents involving exposure to blood & body fluid POL/IPC/10/Vers.1

Monitoring performance:

- An audit should be performed semiannually to determine current performance in terms of safety, efficiency, environmental impact assessment, costs, and regulatory compliance

-All incidents and adverse events related to waste should be recorded. This is essential for identifying the factors that cause waste-handling injuries and determining the effectiveness of the waste management plan in reducing the incidence and severity of these injuries.

References

Title of book/ journal/ articles/ Website	Author	Year of publication	Page
GCC Infection Prevention & Control Manual	GCC center for infection control	2018	58-68
Health Technical Memorandum 07-01 – Safe management of healthcare waste	Department of health UK	2013	
Guidelines for Environmental Infection Control in Health-Care Facilities	CDC	2003	
National guidelines for waste management in the health industry	National health and research medical council	1999	

Review / Revision History

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